

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 718

By Clemmons

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the CSX Santa Train.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing those estimable organizations that have a longstanding tradition of uplifting the children of this State who are most in need; and

WHEREAS, for eighty-three years, the CSX Santa Train has been one of the nation's most cherished holiday traditions, bringing joy and hope to the heart of Appalachia; and

WHEREAS, since 1943, the Santa Train has made a 110-mile journey through Kentucky, Virginia, and Tennessee, with Santa and his elves tossing toys, handing out backpacks filled with supplies, and spreading Christmas cheer to children and their families; and

WHEREAS, in 2025, the CSX Santa Train provided more than 15,000 toys, 6,000 train safety books, and 5,000 bags with cold-weather gear to the hundreds of individuals who were gathered along its route, which spanned from Shelby, Kentucky, to Kingsport, Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, the Santa Train is made possible by devoted volunteers, CSX employees who spend weeks packing all the backpacks with toys, and community partners, including Appalachian Power, Food City, and the Kingsport Chamber of Commerce; and

WHEREAS, for more than eight decades, the CSX Santa Train has brought joy, hope, and Christmas magic to children who might not otherwise receive any gifts for the holiday; and

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that we recognize one of this State's most exemplary charitable events at this time; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize and commend the CSX Santa Train for its compassionate

service to the children of the Central Appalachian region, extending our deepest gratitude to all who help make it possible each year.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.